SUBTRACTING MIXED NUMBERS

Borrowing changes the spelling, not the value

To take $2\frac{3}{4}$ from $5\frac{1}{4}$, one whole is moved into the fraction part first.

BEFORE

Standard mixed number

$$5\frac{1}{4}$$

Fraction part $\frac{1}{4}$ is smaller than $\frac{3}{4}$

BORROW 1

take one whole and rewrite it as $\frac{4}{4}$

FINISH THE SUBTRACTION

AFTER

Borrowed form

$$4\frac{5}{4}$$

Now $\frac{5}{4} - \frac{3}{4}$ can be done directly

WHAT CHANGED One whole moved from the whole part into the fraction part, as $\frac{4}{4}$.

WHAT STAYED The value: $5\frac{1}{4}$ and $4\frac{5}{4}$ are the same number.